

**ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4****PART A Group Interaction**

Below is an extract from an Australian website about a primary school programme called 'Adopt-A-Grandparent':

**About Adopt-A-Grandparent**

The Australian Adopt-A-Grandparent programme is supported by people who have family spread around the country and even the world. Many of our young children do not have grandparents living close by. In fact some of our children don't have any grandparents at all.

Those families who don't have grandparents around find that their children lack the presence of an older role model and often don't know how to relate to and communicate with our older generation. The real shame is that our older generation has so much to offer children by way of skills, knowledge and nurturing.

**What is The Adopt-A-Grandparent Programme?**

Primary schools invite senior volunteers to come to the school and spend time with the children. They read to them, get involved in creative activities, crafts, and play music. Some seniors might tell their story about how things were when they were a kid, something the children love to hear about.

Depending on the scheduling system in each school, seniors can volunteer once a month, once a fortnight, or even more frequently. It is totally up to them to express their preference to the school.

**Grandparent/Senior Volunteers**

Schools invite the grandparents of the children who attend the school to volunteer on a regular basis. Alternatively, senior communities in the area of the school can be approached and invited to participate.

Your group is meeting to discuss whether it would be a good idea to start an Adopt-A-Grandparent programme at your school. You may want to talk about:

- what the grandparents could do and why
- the benefits of such a programme for the students and the school
- how you might organize the programme
- anything else you think is important

**PART B Individual Response**

1. Do you like to spend time with old people?
2. Do you have a favourite older relative?
3. What do your older family members do that makes you happy?
4. What things can you learn from your older family members?
5. Do you think older people make better teachers?
6. Do you think older people can still contribute to society?
7. Do you think that young people are losing touch with the older generation?
8. When your grandparents were young, how different were their lives from yours?